

UNIT 1 · TOPIC 1.11

Booking Process in the Airline Industry

From “search flights” to “ticket issued” — every click explained.

B.B.A. Aviation Management · Semester III · Unit 1: Overview of the Airline Industry
Air Ticketing & Fare Construction (2ACBAM32) · Arun Kumar

**BOARDING PASS**

LEARNER

STU

PROFESSIONAL

**PRO**

FLIGHT

ATF 1.11

GATE

PERIOD 11

DURATION

00:40

SEAT

SEM III

CLASS

HANDS-ON

BOARDING

NOW

TOPIC 1.11

In-Flight Movie: Topic Intro



Air Ticketing & Fare Construction · Unit 1: Overview of the Airline Industry · Topic 1.11

02

TOPIC 1.11

Pre-Flight Question



THINK ABOUT IT

How many steps happen between “search flights” and “ticket issued”? Guess the number.

**THINK**

30 seconds alone

**PAIR**

1 minute with a neighbour

**SHARE**

2-3 answers with the class



TOPIC 1.11

Today's Flight Plan

1

1.11.1

Step-by-step booking process: from reservation to ticket issuance

2

1.11.2

Booking engine interfaces: how online systems interact with customers

3

1.11.3

Booking workflows: agent booking vs self-booking via OTAs

4

1.11.4

Payment processes: methods, security and fraud prevention

**BY LANDING, YOU WILL**

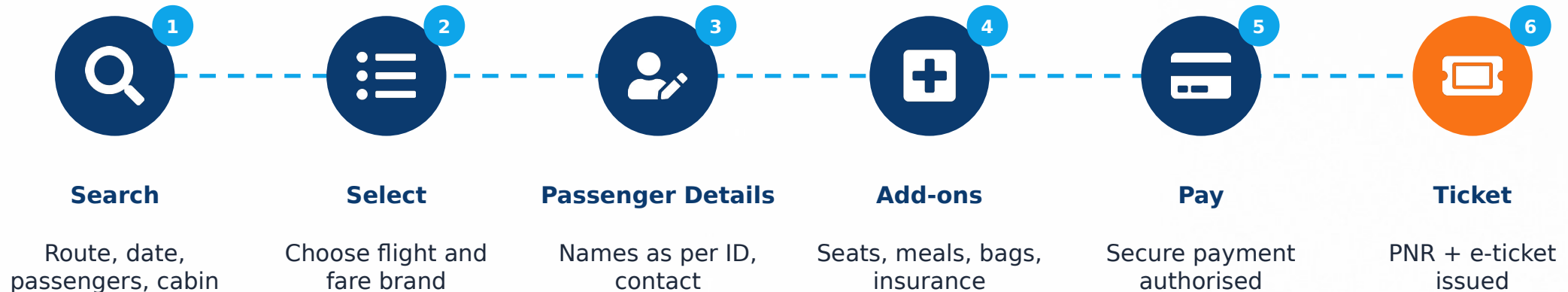
- Sequence the complete booking-to-ticket process
- Describe the parts of an internet booking engine
- Compare agent-assisted and self-service workflows
- Explain secure payment and fraud controls

Pedagogy: Kinesthetic Learning

TOPIC 1.11.1

The Booking Journey: 6 Steps

Whether by agent or app, the logic is the same.



TOPIC 1.11.1

Reservation vs Ticket: Don't Mix Them Up

**Reservation (PNR)**

Holds the seat. Can expire at the ticketing time limit if unpaid.

**Ticket**

Proof of payment and right to travel. Has a 13-digit number.

**Time Limit**

Unticketed bookings are auto-cancelled after the TTL.

**Itinerary Receipt**

Document sent to the passenger showing PNR, ticket and fare.



TOPIC 1.11.2

Inside an Internet Booking Engine (IBE)

The IBE is the airline's or OTA's online shop window.

**Front end**

Search form, calendar of fares, filters, fare-brand comparison and seat map.

**Back end**

Connects to the CRS/GDS or NDC API for live availability and pricing.

**Mobile first**

Most bookings in India now happen on phones — speed and simplicity win.

**UX MATTERS**

Every extra step loses customers. Good IBEs show the total price early, remember passenger details and make add-ons optional, not confusing.



TOPIC 1.11.2

Key IBE Screens

Open any airline app and you will find these.

**Fare Calendar**

Shows the cheapest price per day to encourage flexible travel.

**Fare Brands**

Side-by-side Saver / Flexi / Business with inclusions.

**Seat Map**

Interactive map with free and paid seats.

**Review & Pay**

Final price breakdown, fare rules link, payment options.



TOPIC 1.11.3

Agent Booking vs Self-Booking



Agent-Assisted

- Uses GDS, NDC or airline B2B portals
- Handles complex, group, corporate itineraries
- Expert advice on fares, visas, rules
- May charge a service fee

VS



Self-Booking (OTA / Airline)

- Customer searches and books alone
- Fast and convenient for simple trips
- Relies on clear screens and chat support
- Customer responsible for entering data correctly



TOPIC 1.11.3

Which Workflow Fits Which Traveller?

Traveller	Best workflow	Why
Student, simple domestic trip	Self-booking app	Cheap, quick, easy to compare
Family of 5, international	Agent or OTA	Visas, multiple passengers, advice
Corporate executive	TMC / Self-booking tool	Company policy, negotiated fares
Pilgrim group of 40	Agent (group desk)	Group fares, name lists, deposits
Multi-city with stopovers	Agent	Complex fare construction

TOPIC 1.11.4

Payment Methods

India has one of the most diverse payment landscapes in the world.



Cards

Credit and debit cards (Visa, Mastercard, RuPay).



UPI

Instant bank transfers via apps like Google Pay, PhonePe, Paytm.



Wallets & BNPL

Digital wallets, EMI and buy-now-pay-later.



Agency / BSP

IATA agents settle with airlines through BSP.



TOPIC 1.11.4

Security & Fraud Prevention



PCI DSS

Global security standard for storing and processing card data.



3-D Secure & OTP

Extra authentication (OTP) — mandatory for most card payments in India.



Tokenisation

Real card numbers replaced by secure tokens.



Fraud Checks

Flag last-minute one-way bookings, mismatched names or many cards from one device.

TOPIC 1.11

Cabin Crew Activity: Booking Flow Relay

**PEDAGOGY****Kinesthetic Learning****TIME · 12 min****FORMAT · Teams of 6****1**

Each team gets shuffled cards: search, select, details, add-ons, pay, ticket, plus 3 “trap” cards.

2

Team members walk up one at a time and place a card in the right order on the board.

3

Remove the trap cards and explain why they don’t belong.

4

Fastest correct team explains one fraud check at the payment step.



TOPIC 1.11*Click to reveal each answer*

Pre-Landing Check

Q1**What is created first in the booking process?**

- A) E-ticket
- B) Reservation (PNR)
- C) Boarding pass
- D) Refund

ANSWER**B****Q2****IBE stands for...**

- A) Internet Booking Engine
- B) International Booking Entry
- C) Integrated Baggage Engine
- D) In-flight Booking Entry

ANSWER**A****Q3****The global standard for card data security is...**

- A) NDC
- B) PCI DSS
- C) IATA 722
- D) ATPCO

ANSWER**B****Q4****Which traveller most needs an agent?**

- A) Student, one-way domestic
- B) Pilgrim group of 40
- C) Frequent app user
- D) Day trip commuter

ANSWER**B**

SAFE LANDING

Key Takeaways

- ✓ Booking flow: search, select, details, add-ons, pay, ticket
- ✓ The IBE links the customer interface to live airline inventory
- ✓ Agents suit complex trips; self-booking suits simple ones
- ✓ Secure payments use PCI DSS, OTP/3-D Secure and fraud checks

EXIT TICKET Write 1 thing you learned today + 1 question you still have.

NEXT DEPARTURE**Topic 1.12 — Wrap-Up & Case-Based Learning**

Thank you · Questions?